

Getting Started Guide

A quick walkthrough for setting up your company on RFQ Hub

Welcome to RFQ Hub! You've been invited to set up your own company account on the platform. This guide walks you through everything you need to get your first Request for Quotation (RFQ) live — from activating your account to inviting contractors and reviewing their submissions.

RFQ Hub gives your company its own branded space to create RFQs, manage contractor invitations, and track submissions — all in one place, independent of any other company on the platform.

In this guide

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- Step 2 — Log in (and reset your password if you forget it)
- Step 3 — Set up your company profile
- Step 4 — Create an RFQ: save, preview, and publish
- Step 5 — Manage your RFQs from the Console
- Step 6 — Review submissions
- Step 7 — Invite your team, and control what they can do
- Open vs. Closed RFQs — what's the difference?
- Need help?

STEP 1 Activate Your Account

You'll receive an email invitation to join RFQ Hub. Click the link in that email — it will open RFQ Hub with your account already recognised, and prompt you to choose a password.

- Enter a password (at least 6 characters) and confirm it.
- Click “Set Password & Continue.”
- You'll be taken straight into your company dashboard — no separate sign-up step required.

The password screen you'll see after clicking your invite link

Choose a Password

You've been invited to RFQ Hub. Set a password to finish setting up your account.

New Password *

Confirm Password *

Set Password & Continue

STEP 2 Log In

Once your password is set, you can return to RFQ Hub at any time by clicking “Log In” in the top-right corner and entering your email and password.

The staff login screen

Staff Login

Email

thabo@coastalfab.co.za

Password

.....

Log In

[Forgot your password?](#)

No account yet? Access is by invitation — ask your company admin or the platform admin to invite you.

Forgotten your password?

Click “Forgot your password?” on the login screen and enter your email. If an account exists for that address, you'll receive a 6-digit code by email — enter it along with your new password to reset it. Keep the site open while you check your inbox, and use the code promptly: it's valid for a limited time and can only be used once.

Resetting your password with the 6-digit email code

Reset Your Password

Enter the email address on your account and we'll send you a 6-digit code to set a new password.

If an account exists for that email, a 6-digit code is on its way. KEEP THIS SITE OPEN and check your inbox (and spam folder) — the code is valid for a limited time and can only be used once.

6-Digit Code

4 8 2 9 1 3

New Password *

••••••

Confirm New Password *

••••••

Reset Password

[Back to Sign In](#)

STEP 3 Set Up Your Company Profile

Your dashboard is organised into sections listed down the left-hand side — Create RFQ, RFQ Console, Review Submissions, Team, and Settings. Before creating your first RFQ, open Settings and add your company details. This information appears on every RFQ link and submission page you send to contractors, so it's worth getting right from the start.

- Upload your company logo (PNG, JPG, SVG or WebP — it uploads immediately). It shows up both here and next to your company name at the top of your dashboard. A “Logo Size” slider lets you scale it to fit your logo's proportions.
- Confirm your company name.
- Add a contact email, phone number, and address so contractors know how to reach you.

Company Settings — logo, name, and contact details

Company Settings

This information is shown to contractors on your RFQ links.

Logo



No file chosen

PNG, JPG, SVG or WebP. Uploads immediately.

Logo Size

100%



Scales your logo in the site header and on the public RFQ portal. The preview above matches the header size.

Company Name *

Coombs Trading

Contact Email

info@coombstrading.co.za

Contact Phone

011 555 0142

Address

12 Bridge Street, Sandton, Gauteng

Save Settings

STEP 4 Create an RFQ — Save, Preview, and Publish

Open the “Create RFQ” tab and fill in the fields below. RFQ Hub now separates saving your work from actually sending it out, so you can take your time getting an RFQ right before anyone outside your company sees it.

 Saving — whether it's “Save Draft” or “Save RFQ” — never makes an RFQ public and never notifies or emails anyone.  “Publish RFQ” is the only action that does that, whether you click it here on the form or later from the Console.

-  Preview — shows exactly how the RFQ will look to a contractor, using whatever you've typed so far. Nothing is saved or sent.
-  Save Draft — saves your progress as a draft you can come back to later. Only the RFQ name, project, description, and deadline are required to save a draft; everything else can be filled in over time.
-  Save RFQ — finalizes the RFQ (moving it out of Draft) without publishing it. It's saved in the Console, fully editable, but still invisible to anyone outside your company.
-  Publish RFQ — saves the RFQ and makes it live in one step: an Open RFQ goes onto the public portal and registered suppliers are notified; a Closed RFQ's invite links are emailed to the contractors you listed.

The Create RFQ form

Create New RFQ

RFQ Name/Title *

Project Name *

Province(s) *
Select every province you want this RFQ to be visible in and to notify registered suppliers in.

☐ **Select All Provinces**

☐ Eastern Cape
☐ Free State
☒ Gauteng
☐ KwaZulu-Natal
☐ Limpopo
☐ Mpumalanga
☐ Northern Cape
☐ North West
☒ Western Cape

Town / Area (optional)

Required Documents *
Click the button below to add document types contractors must submit

Remove

☒ Mandatory for submission
☒ Requires an expiry date (e.g. COIDA, insurance)

Remove

☒ Mandatory for submission
☐ Requires an expiry date (e.g. COIDA, insurance)

Matches a Supplier Database document?

If linked, a registered supplier who already has this document on file can reuse it instead of uploading again.

 Save never makes an RFQ public or notifies anyone.  Publish RFQ is the only button that does — here, or on it later from the Console.

Field guide

Field	Required?	What it's for
RFQ Name/Title	Required	A short, clear title, e.g. "Safety Equipment Quotes."
Project Name	Required	The project this RFQ relates to.
Description	Required	Details of what you're looking for.
Province(s)	Required	Tick every province this RFQ applies to — you're no longer limited to one. Used for the portal's province filter and to decide which registered suppliers get notified.
Town / Area	Optional	A more specific location within the province(s).
Submission Deadline	Required	The date and time contractors must submit by.
Budget	Optional	An indicative budget. If provided, it's shown to contractors on the RFQ page.
Visibility	Required	Open (listed on the public portal) or Closed (invite-only) — see below.
Required Documents	Required	The document types contractors must submit. For each one you can mark it Mandatory (blocks submission if missing), require an Expiry Date (e.g. an insurance certificate or COIDA letter — flags it if it had already expired when submitted), or link it to a Supplier Database document (CIPC, Proof of Address, or SARS Info) so a returning supplier can reuse what they already have on file instead of re-uploading.
Attach RFQ Document(s)	Optional	Upload specs, drawings, or other files for contractors to download before applying.
Contractor Email Addresses	Required for Closed RFQs	One email per line. Each contractor gets a personal invite link — emailed once you Publish, not immediately on save.

Open vs. Closed RFQs

When you create an RFQ, you choose whether it's Open or Closed. This controls who can see and apply to it.

Visibility	What happens
Closed — Invite Only	Only reachable via the invite links you send — emailed once you Publish. Not listed anywhere public. Contractor email addresses are required.
Open — Public Portal	Listed on the public "Open RFQs" portal once Published, with your company logo and name shown, and registered suppliers in your chosen province(s) are emailed (and texted, where a number is on file). Contractor email addresses are optional — you can still invite specific people in addition to the public listing.

The public portal lets people filter open RFQs by province, so accurate location details help the right contractors find your listing.

How an Open RFQ appears on the public portal

OPEN

BC LOGO

COOMBS TRADING

Supply of Cleaning Services

Ongoing office cleaning services for our Sandton head office, including consumables.

CLOSING DATE

8/27/2026 at 02:50 PM

LOCATION

Sandton, Gauteng

PROJECT

Facilities Management

TIME REMAINING

8 23 59

DAYS HRS MINS

View Opportunity

STEP 5 Manage Your RFQs from the Console

The “RFQ Console” tab lists every RFQ you've created — drafts, saved-but-not-yet-published RFQs, and published ones all together — with a live response rate showing how many invited/interested contractors have submitted, and how many days are left before the deadline.

- A  Draft card only offers Continue Editing and Delete Draft — it isn't finalized yet.
- A  Not Released Yet card is a saved, finalized RFQ that hasn't gone out — click  Edit RFQ to keep refining it, or  Publish RFQ when you're ready for it to go live.
- Once published,  Edit RFQ is still available for changes (saving never re-notifies anyone), and an Open RFQ additionally gets  Expand Supplier Search (invite registered suppliers in provinces you didn't originally target) and  Unpublish (reversibly pull it off the public portal — existing submissions are kept, and it can be  Republished later).

RFQ Console — a draft, a not-yet-published RFQ, and a live Open RFQ

Site Security Services

DRAFT

Project: Table Bay Construction Site

Not visible to contractors — no notifications are sent until this is saved and released. Last saved 26 Aug 2026, 14:02.

Continue Editing

Delete Draft

Safety Equipment Quotes

NOT RELEASED YET

Project: Table Bay Construction Site

Table Bay, Cape Town, Gauteng, Western Cape

Saved, not yet public — nothing has been sent to suppliers or contractors. Click Publish RFQ below when ready.

Deadline: 2026/09/15 20 days left

Response Rate

0%

0/3 responses

Edit RFQ

Publish RFQ

Fabrication & Welding Services

OPEN — PUBLIC

Project: Coastal Refinery Expansion

Gauteng, Western Cape

Suppliers notified in: Gauteng, Western Cape

Deadline: 2026/09/30 35 days left

Response Rate

63%

5/8 responses

Edit RFQ

+ Add Contractor

Copy All Links

Expand Supplier Search

Unpublish

STEP 6 Review Submissions

As contractors submit quotations, they appear in the “Review Submissions” tab. Filter by RFQ or status, open a submission to see the contractor's details and documents, and update its status as you work through it (Submitted → Under Review → Approved/Rejected). If a teammate's access has been limited by the company owner (see Step 7), they may see fewer statuses here than you do.

Review Submissions — filter and manage contractor responses

RFQ Submissions

All RFQs

All Statuses

BrightClean Services

Email: sales@brightclean.co.za RFQ: Supply of Cleaning Services Submitted: 8/16/2026

UNDER REVIEW

Prime Supplies & Services

Email: quotes@primesupplies.co.za RFQ: Supply of Cleaning Services Submitted: 8/17/2026

INFO REQUESTED

Technovation Distributors

Email: sales@technovation.co.za RFQ: IT Hardware Refresh Submitted: 8/18/2026

SUBMITTED

Asking a contractor for more information

If a submission is missing something — a certificate, a clearer figure, an extra document — open it and choose “Request More Information” from the status dropdown instead of Approved/Rejected. Describe what you need, then click “Send Request.”

- The contractor receives an email with your message and a link — no login required on their side.
- They can reply with a message and upload documents directly to their existing submission.
- The submission's status updates automatically (Info Requested → Response Received) so you can see at a glance who you're waiting on.

Requesting more information from a submission

BrightClean Services

×

COMPANY NAME

BrightClean Services

EMAIL

sales@brightclean.co.za

PHONE

082 456 1290

REG NUMBER

2018/045213/07

RFQ: Supply of Cleaning Services

Project: Facilities Management

Deadline: 8/27/2026

SUBMITTED

8/16/2026, 2:50:37 PM

Uploaded Documents

No documents submitted

WHAT INFORMATION DO YOU NEED FROM THE CONTRACTOR?

Please send your latest BBBEE certificate and confirm your VAT registration number.

Close

Request More Information

Send Request

STEP 7 Invite Your Team

Need colleagues to help manage RFQs? Click Team in the left-hand menu to see everyone with access and invite new teammates by email. Each person you invite gets their own login and goes through the same activation step as you did in Step 1.

Team — see current members and invite new teammates

Team

People with access to this company's RFQ Hub admin section.

thabo@coastalfab.co.za (you)

Full access (owner)

Owner

naledi@coastalfab.co.za

Limited access (2/6 stages)

Staff

Permissions

Invite a Teammate

Email *

Send Invite

Controlling what a teammate can do in Review Submissions

By default, a teammate you invite has full access to every submission stage, the same as you. As the company owner, you can narrow this: click  Permissions next to any teammate (not shown for the owner's own row) to open a grid covering all six submission stages — Submitted, Under Review, Request More Information, Response Received, Approved, and Rejected — with View and Edit checkboxes for each. Edit always includes View. A teammate with, say, only Approved and Rejected access will see just those statuses in their filters, and can only move a submission into one of those two stages.

- Leave a teammate unrestricted if you want them to have the same access as you.
- Tick only the stages a teammate needs — for example, a junior team member who should only flag submissions as “Under Review” without approving or rejecting them.
- This is enforced by RFQ Hub itself, not just hidden on screen — a restricted teammate genuinely cannot move a submission into a stage they don't have Edit access to.

Setting a teammate's per-stage View/Edit permissions

Review Submissions Permissions ×

naledi@coastalfab.co.za

Control which submission stages this teammate can see and act on.
"Edit" automatically includes "View".

Submitted	☒ View	☒ Edit
Under Review	☒ View	☒ Edit
Request More Information	☐ View	☐ Edit
Response Received	☐ View	☐ Edit
Approved	☒ View	☒ Edit
Rejected	☐ View	☐ Edit

A teammate you've never restricted has full access to every stage by default.

Save Permissions

A note on passwords

You can change your own password at any time from Settings → Change Password. This doesn't affect any other team member's login.

Need Help?

If you run into any issues getting set up, or anything in this guide doesn't match what you're seeing on screen, reach out and we'll help you sort it out.

- **Email:** ihubsa@gmail.com
- **Email:** admin@public-rfq-hub.co.za
- **Or click the WhatsApp button in the bottom-right corner of your dashboard for a quick chat.**

Once you're registered and up and running, a full in-app manual will also be available directly within RFQ Hub.